

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ A 8 4 2

♦ 5

♣ K 9 4 2

♠ 9 3

♥ K Q

♦ A K Q J 9 3

♣ Q 8 3



♠ 7 4 2

♥ J 10 9 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 6

♠ A K Q 5

♥ 7 5

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A 10 7 5

West	North	East	South
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			1 ♣
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Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠
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Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
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Pass	6NT		
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All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥J

Then start running the ♦ suit.

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥J. West wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

The solution is the Vienna Coup. Play a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

West is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ K 9 8 6 3
 ♦ A 6
 ♣ A K Q 5

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ J 10 9 3



♠ K 7
 ♥ A Q J 7 5 2
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ 7 6 4

♠ Q J 10 6 4

♥ 10

♦ 10 9 7 4 2

♣ 8 2

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♥	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			
Lead: ♠Q			

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

North has no answer.

East is to play 6♥. South leads the ♠Q. North wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

North's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against North. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
♥ K Q 10 7 5
♦ 10 8 4
♣ J 9 5 2

♠ A 5 2

♥ J 6

♦ A K J 7 5 3

♣ K 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 9 6 4

♥ 9 8 3 2

♦ -

♣ Q 10 6 3

♠ K Q 7 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A 8 4

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by South

Lead: ♥K
with 5 ♠s.

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♥K.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against West's ♥Q, so if it is West who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A East discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦K, East discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since East has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough West discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze West in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, East does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "West must guard ♥s, and East must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

When you play the ♦5 East must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

West has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

[showcards N:S5,HJ,CK,C7 E:SJ,ST,CQ,CT S:SK,CA,C8,C4 W:HQ,CJ,C9,C5]

It is now time to pressure West.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

West MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 7 4
 ♥ A K 5
 ♦ K Q 10
 ♣ A K 2

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ J 10 7 2

♦ 6 3

♣ 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 5 2

♥ 6

♦ A J 9 7 4

♣ Q 8 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q 9 8 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ J 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	3♦	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♦	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			
7NT by West			
Lead: ♠Q			

West is to play 7NT. North leads the ♠Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠K and play ♣ A K Q.

North discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know South guards the ♣s.

Before tackling ♦s, see what you can discover about ♠s.

Play the ♠A. South discards a ♥.

South guards the ♣s. North guards the ♠s. Nobody can guard the ♥s.

Play 4 rounds of ♦s.

[showcards N:S9,H6,D4,C8 E:HQ,H9,H8,CJ S:S7,HA,HK,H5 W:SJ,HJ,HT,H7]

On the fourth ♦ South had to discard a ♥. You discarded a small ♠. North discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

Play dummy's ♦4. South cannot throw the ♣J or he will set up dummy's ♣8, so he discards a ♥.

You discard the ♠7.

Now North is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠J or he will set up dummy's ♠9, so he discards a ♥.

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 6 2
♥ 7 5 2
♦ J 9 8 4 3
♣ J 4

♠ 5
♥ A K J 9 8 3
♦ A 5
♣ K 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K J 9 4
♥ 6 4
♦ 10 7 2
♣ Q 10 2

♠ 10 8 7 3
♥ Q 10
♦ K Q 6
♣ A 9 7 5

West	North	East	South
	1♥	1♠	2♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by North

Lead: ♠A

Now play the ♦A, ♦K, and ♦Q, discarding the ♣3 from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣7 to your ♣K.

[showcards N:ST,CA,C9 E:DJ,D9,CJ S:HA,C8,C6 W:SJ,CQ,CT]

Here you are in your hand.

Only East can guard dummy's ♠10, and only East can guard dummy's ♣9.

So you play your ♥A and East must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠J then you toss dummy's useless ♠10. If he throws the ♠J then you toss dummy's ♣9.

North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If East holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze East in the black suits right now is that West actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

Play dummy's ♥Q and ♥10, then ruff a ♠, then pull the last trump.